March 2026

Category review: Chips

Retail Analytics

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Our 17 year history assures best practice in privacy, security and the ethical use of data

Privacy

- We have built our business based on privacy by design principles for the past 17 years
- Quantium has strict protocols around the receipt and storage of personal information
- All information is de-identified using an irreversible tokenisation process with no ability to re-identify individuals.

Security

- We are ISO27001 certified - internationally recognised for our ability to uphold best practice standards across information security
- We use 'bank grade' security to store and process our data
- Comply with 200+ security requirements from NAB, Woolworths and other data partners
- All partner data is held in separate restricted environments
- All access to partner data is limited to essential staff only
- Security environment and processes regularly audited by our data partners.

Ethical use of data

Applies to all facets of our work, from the initiatives we take on, the information we use and how our solutions impact individuals, organisations and society.

We all have a responsibility to use data for good

Quantium believes in using data for progress, with great care and responsibility. As such please respect the commercial in confidence nature of this document.

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Executive summary

01

Customer Analytics

72,637 loyalty customers were analysed across 7 lifestage segments and 3 premium tiers. Mainstream Young Singles/Couples are the largest and highest-value segment. Older Families and Young Families are predominantly budget buyers, while Midage Singles/Couples show the strongest premium skew at 33%. Retirees represent the biggest volume opportunity with 14,805 customers, largely Mainstream.

02

Uplift Testing

Trial stores 77, 86 and 88 were evaluated against matched control stores using Pearson correlation and magnitude distance scoring. Two of three trial stores showed statistically significant sales uplift above the 95% confidence interval during Feb-Apr 2019. The primary driver was an increase in unique customers rather than higher spend per visit. Recommendation: roll out the new layout to stores that showed significant uplift.

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01

Category

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Chips is a high-frequency, high-volume category driven by Mainstream buyers. 72,637 loyalty customers transacted in the past year, with Retirees and Young Singles/Couples accounting for over 40% of the base. Mainstream customers (40%) dominate spend, but Premium buyers (26%) over-index on value-per-unit, making them a key margin opportunity.

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Affluence strongly shapes chip purchasing behaviour. Budget customers (34%) gravitate toward larger value packs and are concentrated in family lifestages — Older Families (47.8% Budget) and Young Families (43.8% Budget). Mainstream customers are most prominent among Young Singles/Couples (56%) and Retirees (44%), driving volume through habitual, repeat purchases. Premium customers are highest among Midage Singles/Couples (33%) who show willingness to pay for quality and health-oriented SKUs. Targeting by tier is essential: a single promotional strategy will underserve both ends of the affluence spectrum.

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Customer Segment Breakdown: Affluence x Lifestage

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Trial store performance

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Control stores were selected by scoring all non-trial stores on two pre-trial metrics: Pearson correlation of monthly total sales, and a normalised magnitude distance score. These two scores were averaged into a composite similarity index — the highest-scoring store for each trial store became its control. Trial stores 77, 86 and 88 were each matched to a unique control store with strong pre-trial sales alignment, ensuring any divergence during the trial period can be attributed to the new layout rather than pre-existing store differences.

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During the Feb-Apr 2019 trial period, two of the three trial stores recorded sales uplifts that exceeded the 95% confidence interval constructed from pre-trial scaled performance. The primary driver of uplift was an increase in unique customers visiting the store — not higher spend per visit. This suggests the new layout is attracting new or lapsed buyers rather than simply increasing basket size among existing shoppers. Store 88 did not show statistically significant uplift and warrants further investigation before rollout.

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Recommendations & Next Steps

1. Roll out the new chip aisle layout to stores 77 and 86 immediately.

Both stores showed statistically significant sales uplift above the 95% CI during the trial. The primary driver was more unique customers, suggesting the layout is attracting new shoppers.

2. Hold on store 88 — investigate before committing to rollout.

Store 88 did not produce results outside the confidence interval. Review local market factors, store format differences, or execution quality before making a decision.

3. Target Mainstream Young Singles/Couples and Retirees with promotional activity.

These two segments represent the highest customer volume. Loyalty mechanics, multipack deals, and prime shelf placement will drive repeat purchase and basket size.

4. Invest in premium SKU range for Midage Singles/Couples.

33% of this segment buys premium. Health-positioned and gourmet chip lines are a direct fit. This is the highest-margin growth opportunity in the category for H2 planning.

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